

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ T 5  
 ♥ J T 4 2  
 ♦ 9 6 5 4 3  
 ♣ J 9

♠ A Q 6

♥ A Q 9

♦ A T 7

♣ K Q 7 3



♠ K J 9 4 3

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 8 2

♣ T 6 2

♠ 8 7 2

♥ K 8 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A 8 5 4

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

4-card Major in either hand.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6NT

Lead the ♥6.

You held this identical hand in Deal 3. The declarer was playing 3NT and the best lead was the ♠4, fourth down.

It's different when the contract is 6NT. Against 6NT you should make a passive lead, which means don't underlead any honors. Against 6NT you have little chance of establishing a suit to win four or five tricks. Instead, you just want to try to not give declarer an undeserved trick.

So any passive lead would be OK, you pick the ♥ just because they are less likely to have an unbid

Declarer has 11 winners sitting there; if you had led a low ♠ you would have handed him his 12 trick on a platter.

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 2  
 ♥ A 9 7  
 ♦ T 5 3  
 ♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ Q 9 7 6 3

♥ T 4 3

♦ 4

♣ 9 8 4 3



♠ J T  
 ♥ K Q J  
 ♦ A Q J 9 8 7  
 ♣ J 5

♠ K 8 5 4

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ K 6 2

♣ T 2

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       | 1 ♦  | Pass  |
| 2 ♣         | Pass  | 3 ♦  | Pass  |
| 4NT         | Pass  | 5 ♦  | Pass  |
| 6 ♦         |       |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6 ♦ by East |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6 ♦

Lead the ♠ 4.

Against a notrump slam it is best to make a passive lead so you don't give declarer an undeserved winner.

Against a suit slam the situation is very different. Against strong dummy bidding like this you are pretty sure that if you don't establish a winner early declarer will find something in dummy to discard losers on. In this hand it is dummy's ♣ suit.

Your most promising suit is ♠s. Obviously partner has a very weak hand, but if he has the ♠Q you can set up your ♠K before your King of trumps is dislodged.

Without a ♠ lead declarer will have smooth sailing.

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J T 8  
♥ Q T 5 4 2  
♦ 7 3  
♣ A 3

♠ 9 7 5

♥ J 7

♦ K Q 8

♣ K J 9 8 2



♠ K 6 2

♥ K 6 3

♦ 9 5 4 2

♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3

♥ A 9 8

♦ A J T 6

♣ Q T 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥ 4.

This is a close call. The top of your ♠ honor sequence is very tempting, but even when you find partner with the ♠ K you can still only establish three ♠ winners to go with your ♣ A. Unfortunately, that's not enough to defeat the contract.

Leading a ♥ from your 5-card suit is riskier, but it has the potential of setting up an additional winner. In this hand, as you see, the ♥ lead gets you 4 ♥ winners to go with your ♣ A.

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 9 3  
 ♥ Q J 7 4 3  
 ♦ K  
 ♣ K 8 7 4

♠ 8 4

♥ 9 8 2

♦ A T 5 3

♣ A J 6 2



♠ K J 7 5  
 ♥ A K 6 5  
 ♦ 8 7 4 2  
 ♣ 5

♠ Q T 6 2

♥ T

♦ Q J 9 6

♣ Q T 9 3

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| 1 ♥         | Pass  | 1 ♠  | Pass  |
| 2 ♣         | Pass  | 4 ♥  |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4 ♥ by West |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♥

Underleading an Ace against a suit contract is the absolute worst opening lead in Bridge. A careful look at this hand shows just how bad it can turn out.

And leading from a doubleton in a suit the opponents have bid is almost as bad.

So by process of elimination you lead a trump, probably the ♥9.

And when West plays ♣s, (preparing to ruff in dummy), you will win and play another trump. Even if West guesses the ♠s correctly he will not be able to make the contract.

**Board 5**

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q J 9 3

♥ 4 2

♦ 9 7 6 2

♣ A 5

♠ A T 4

♥ K 9 8

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ J 7 3



♠ 7 6

♥ Q J T 7 3

♦ T 5 3

♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2

♥ A 6 5

♦ K J

♣ K Q T 9 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

partner's suit. If the lead turns out wrong, and the ♥Q lead would have beaten the contract, partner will not blame you in the least. But if you lead the ♥Q and it turns out that a ♠ lead would have let you set the contract, well, that would not be too good for partnership harmony.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠7, the suit your partner overcalled.

If partner had not overcalled, the ♥Q would be the perfect lead against 3NT. But partner DID overcall, perhaps to give you a hint on what to lead if North became declarer.

As you see, a ♠ lead will defeat the contract this time while the ♥Q would let declarer make 11 tricks.

Consider this: even if partner has a high ♥ to help you establish the suit it is not very likely that you would be able to get the lead with your entryless hand.

There is another, more subtle, reason for leading

**Board 6**

East Deals

E-W Vul

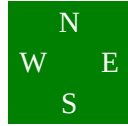
♠ 6 5 2  
♥ 9 5 3 2  
♦ A 6 4  
♣ 9 4 2

♠ K 7

♥ 8 6 4

♦ J 7 2

♣ K Q J T 8



♠ A J 9 3

♥ K J

♦ T 5 3

♣ A 7 6 3

♠ Q T 8 4

♥ A Q T 7

♦ K Q 9 8

♣ 5

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Dbl

All Pass

1 ♣ X by East

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 1 ♣ doubled

Lead the ♣ 5.

There is only one reason partner would pass your takeout double - he has a great ♣ suit and he expects to inflict a large penalty.

What he wants to do is pull East's trumps so your high card winners don't get ruffed by East. The way you can help him do that is to start with a trump lead.

With the trump lead East might not make more than three tricks.

**Board 7**

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ T 5  
♥ J T 4 2  
♦ 9 6 5 4 3  
♣ J 9

♠ A Q 6

♥ A Q 9

♦ A T 7

♣ K Q 7 3



♠ K J 9 4 3

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 8 2

♣ T 6 2

♠ 8 7 2

♥ K 8 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A 8 5 4

**Board 8**

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 2  
♥ A 9 7  
♦ T 5 3  
♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ Q 9 7 6 3

♥ T 4 3

♦ 4

♣ 9 8 4 3



♠ J T

♥ K Q J

♦ A Q J 9 8 7

♣ J 5

♠ K 8 5 4

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ K 6 2

♣ T 2



**Board 9**

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J T 8  
♥ Q T 5 4 2  
♦ 7 3  
♣ A 3

♠ 9 7 5  
♥ J 7  
♦ K Q 8  
♣ K J 9 8 2



♠ K 6 2  
♥ K 6 3  
♦ 9 5 4 2  
♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3  
♥ A 9 8  
♦ A J T 6  
♣ Q T 4

**Board 10**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 9 3  
♥ Q J 7 4 3  
♦ K  
♣ K 8 7 4

♠ 8 4

♥ 9 8 2

♦ A T 5 3

♣ A J 6 2

N

W E

S

♠ K J 7 5

♥ A K 6 5

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ 5

♠ Q T 6 2

♥ T

♦ Q J 9 6

♣ Q T 9 3

**Board 11**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 9 3

♥ 4 2

♦ 9 7 6 2

♣ A 5

♠ A T 4

♥ K 9 8

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ J 7 3



♠ 7 6

♥ Q J T 7 3

♦ T 5 3

♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2

♥ A 6 5

♦ K J

♣ K Q T 9 4

**Board 12**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 5 2  
♥ 9 5 3 2  
♦ A 6 4  
♣ 9 4 2

♠ K 7  
♥ 8 6 4  
♦ J 7 2  
♣ K Q J T 8



♠ A J 9 3  
♥ K J  
♦ T 5 3  
♣ A 7 6 3

♠ Q T 8 4  
♥ A Q T 7  
♦ K Q 9 8  
♣ 5

**Board 13**

North Deals  
Both Vul

♠ T 5  
♥ J T 4 2  
♦ 9 6 5 4 3  
♣ J 9

♠ A Q 6  
♥ A Q 9  
♦ A T 7  
♣ K Q 7 3



♠ K J 9 4 3  
♥ 6 5 3  
♦ 8 2  
♣ T 6 2

♠ 8 7 2  
♥ K 8 7  
♦ K Q J  
♣ A 8 5 4

**Board 14**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 2

♥ A 9 7

♦ T 5 3

♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ Q 9 7 6 3

♥ T 4 3

♦ 4

♣ 9 8 4 3



♠ J T

♥ K Q J

♦ A Q J 9 8 7

♣ J 5

♠ K 8 5 4

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ K 6 2

♣ T 2

**Board 15**

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J T 8  
♥ Q T 5 4 2  
♦ 7 3  
♣ A 3

♠ 9 7 5  
♥ J 7  
♦ K Q 8  
♣ K J 9 8 2



♠ K 6 2  
♥ K 6 3  
♦ 9 5 4 2  
♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3  
♥ A 9 8  
♦ A J T 6  
♣ Q T 4

**Board 16**

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 9 3  
♥ Q J 7 4 3  
♦ K  
♣ K 8 7 4

♠ 8 4

♥ 9 8 2

♦ A T 5 3

♣ A J 6 2



♠ K J 7 5  
♥ A K 6 5  
♦ 8 7 4 2  
♣ 5

♠ Q T 6 2

♥ T

♦ Q J 9 6

♣ Q T 9 3



**Board 17**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 9 3

♥ 4 2

♦ 9 7 6 2

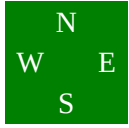
♣ A 5

♠ A T 4

♥ K 9 8

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ J 7 3



♠ 7 6

♥ Q J T 7 3

♦ T 5 3

♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2

♥ A 6 5

♦ K J

♣ K Q T 9 4

**Board 18**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 5 2  
♥ 9 5 3 2  
♦ A 6 4  
♣ 9 4 2

♠ K 7  
♥ 8 6 4  
♦ J 7 2  
♣ K Q J T 8



♠ A J 9 3  
♥ K J  
♦ T 5 3  
♣ A 7 6 3

♠ Q T 8 4  
♥ A Q T 7  
♦ K Q 9 8  
♣ 5

**Board 19**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T 5  
♥ J T 4 2  
♦ 9 6 5 4 3  
♣ J 9

♠ A Q 6  
♥ A Q 9  
♦ A T 7  
♣ K Q 7 3



♠ K J 9 4 3  
♥ 6 5 3  
♦ 8 2  
♣ T 6 2

♠ 8 7 2  
♥ K 8 7  
♦ K Q J  
♣ A 8 5 4

**Board 20**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 2  
♥ A 9 7  
♦ T 5 3  
♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ Q 9 7 6 3  
♥ T 4 3  
♦ 4  
♣ 9 8 4 3



♠ J T  
♥ K Q J  
♦ A Q J 9 8 7  
♣ J 5

♠ K 8 5 4  
♥ 8 6 5 2  
♦ K 6 2  
♣ T 2

**Board 21**

North Deals  
N-S Vul

♠ Q J T 8  
♥ Q T 5 4 2  
♦ 7 3  
♣ A 3

♠ 9 7 5  
♥ J 7  
♦ K Q 8  
♣ K J 9 8 2



♠ K 6 2  
♥ K 6 3  
♦ 9 5 4 2  
♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3  
♥ A 9 8  
♦ A J T 6  
♣ Q T 4

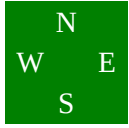
**Board 22**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 9 3  
♥ Q J 7 4 3  
♦ K  
♣ K 8 7 4

♠ 8 4  
♥ 9 8 2  
♦ A T 5 3  
♣ A J 6 2



♠ K J 7 5  
♥ A K 6 5  
♦ 8 7 4 2  
♣ 5

♠ Q T 6 2  
♥ T  
♦ Q J 9 6  
♣ Q T 9 3

**Board 23**

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 9 3

♥ 4 2

♦ 9 7 6 2

♣ A 5

♠ A T 4

♥ K 9 8

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ J 7 3



♠ 7 6

♥ Q J T 7 3

♦ T 5 3

♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2

♥ A 6 5

♦ K J

♣ K Q T 9 4

**Board 24**

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5 2  
♥ 9 5 3 2  
♦ A 6 4  
♣ 9 4 2

♠ K 7  
♥ 8 6 4  
♦ J 7 2  
♣ K Q J T 8

N  
W E  
S

♠ A J 9 3  
♥ K J  
♦ T 5 3  
♣ A 7 6 3

♠ Q T 8 4  
♥ A Q T 7  
♦ K Q 9 8  
♣ 5



**Board 25**

North Deals  
E-W Vul

♠ T 5  
♥ J T 4 2  
♦ 9 6 5 4 3  
♣ J 9

♠ A Q 6  
♥ A Q 9  
♦ A T 7  
♣ K Q 7 3



♠ K J 9 4 3  
♥ 6 5 3  
♦ 8 2  
♣ T 6 2

♠ 8 7 2  
♥ K 8 7  
♦ K Q J  
♣ A 8 5 4

**Board 26**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 2  
♥ A 9 7  
♦ T 5 3  
♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ Q 9 7 6 3

♥ T 4 3

♦ 4

♣ 9 8 4 3



♠ J T

♥ K Q J

♦ A Q J 9 8 7

♣ J 5

♠ K 8 5 4

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ K 6 2

♣ T 2

**Board 27**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J T 8  
♥ Q T 5 4 2  
♦ 7 3  
♣ A 3

♠ 9 7 5  
♥ J 7  
♦ K Q 8  
♣ K J 9 8 2



♠ K 6 2  
♥ K 6 3  
♦ 9 5 4 2  
♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3  
♥ A 9 8  
♦ A J T 6  
♣ Q T 4

**Board 28**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 9 3  
♥ Q J 7 4 3  
♦ K  
♣ K 8 7 4

♠ 8 4  
♥ 9 8 2  
♦ A T 5 3  
♣ A J 6 2



♠ K J 7 5  
♥ A K 6 5  
♦ 8 7 4 2  
♣ 5

♠ Q T 6 2  
♥ T  
♦ Q J 9 6  
♣ Q T 9 3

**Board 29**

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 9 3

♥ 4 2

♦ 9 7 6 2

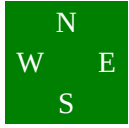
♣ A 5

♠ A T 4

♥ K 9 8

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ J 7 3



♠ 7 6

♥ Q J T 7 3

♦ T 5 3

♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2

♥ A 6 5

♦ K J

♣ K Q T 9 4

**Board 30**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5 2  
♥ 9 5 3 2  
♦ A 6 4  
♣ 9 4 2

♠ K 7  
♥ 8 6 4  
♦ J 7 2  
♣ K Q J T 8



♠ A J 9 3  
♥ K J  
♦ T 5 3  
♣ A 7 6 3

♠ Q T 8 4  
♥ A Q T 7  
♦ K Q 9 8  
♣ 5

**Board 31**

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ T 5  
♥ J T 4 2  
♦ 9 6 5 4 3  
♣ J 9

♠ A Q 6  
♥ A Q 9  
♦ A T 7  
♣ K Q 7 3



♠ K J 9 4 3  
♥ 6 5 3  
♦ 8 2  
♣ T 6 2

♠ 8 7 2  
♥ K 8 7  
♦ K Q J  
♣ A 8 5 4

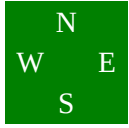
**Board 32**

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 2  
♥ A 9 7  
♦ T 5 3  
♣ A K Q 7 6

♠ Q 9 7 6 3  
♥ T 4 3  
♦ 4  
♣ 9 8 4 3



♠ J T  
♥ K Q J  
♦ A Q J 9 8 7  
♣ J 5

♠ K 8 5 4  
♥ 8 6 5 2  
♦ K 6 2  
♣ T 2



**Board 33**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J T 8  
♥ Q T 5 4 2  
♦ 7 3  
♣ A 3

♠ 9 7 5  
♥ J 7  
♦ K Q 8  
♣ K J 9 8 2



♠ K 6 2  
♥ K 6 3  
♦ 9 5 4 2  
♣ 7 6 5

♠ A 4 3  
♥ A 9 8  
♦ A J T 6  
♣ Q T 4

**Board 34**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 9 3  
♥ Q J 7 4 3  
♦ K  
♣ K 8 7 4

♠ 8 4

♥ 9 8 2

♦ A T 5 3

♣ A J 6 2

N  
W E  
S

♠ K J 7 5

♥ A K 6 5

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ 5

♠ Q T 6 2

♥ T

♦ Q J 9 6

♣ Q T 9 3

**Board 35**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q J 9 3

♥ 4 2

♦ 9 7 6 2

♣ A 5

♠ A T 4

♥ K 9 8

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ J 7 3



♠ 7 6

♥ Q J T 7 3

♦ T 5 3

♣ 8 6 2

♠ 8 5 2

♥ A 6 5

♦ K J

♣ K Q T 9 4

**Board 36**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 5 2  
♥ 9 5 3 2  
♦ A 6 4  
♣ 9 4 2

♠ K 7  
♥ 8 6 4  
♦ J 7 2  
♣ K Q J T 8



♠ A J 9 3  
♥ K J  
♦ T 5 3  
♣ A 7 6 3

♠ Q T 8 4  
♥ A Q T 7  
♦ K Q 9 8  
♣ 5